

CHAPTER SEVEN

Headquarters Duty

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We spent a little time in California but the majority of it in Utah where it was a cold 14 degrees most of the time. While there we had the opportunity to visit and have dinner with the Lee's and the Kimball's again, having duly delivered the nutria coat to Elder Lee for Sister Lee's surprise Christmas present. We also went with Helen and Jay up to Heber and the hot springs up there which was fun.

Before returning to Washington we flew to New Jersey to pick up a new Ford Falcon which we had ordered when we were still in Uruguay. Our house on Sable Drive had been rented while we were gone and our neighbor, Werner Dickenson, had it all ready to go when we returned from Utah so we were able to move right in instead of staying in temporary quarters as we usually had to do.

Introduction back into stateside life is always a bit difficult. When one lives overseas you get accustomed to living with servants and having extra cars at your disposal so getting back to the real world takes a little time. Also, since it was in the middle of the school year we had to make arrangements to get the kids placed in their proper year at school, somewhat of a task since they were coming from a British school system. Generally speaking, however, things went pretty well. Ron was placed a half-year ahead and Gail was put in her proper class. There was no problem with Patty-she had really been going to what amounted to kindergarden when she was in Uruguay.

Since we had moved back into the same area that we had left about two and a half years earlier, we were still in the Alexandria Ward, with Bp. Olsen. In February, 1960 I was called on a Stake mission and served as president of the district. My companion was named Billy Moore and we were reasonably successful in our missionary activities. One of our converts was named Freeman Lee, a nuclear physicist, who had to be taught to believe in God and the Bible before teaching such things as the atonement of Jesus Christ, and the Plan of Salvation. It took a lot of work but eventually he and his wife and two children were all baptized.

Upon returning to work at the Agency, I was assigned to SR Division, Requirements Branch, responsible for providing intelligence collection assignments to field agents, working through their case officers. I had requested this assignment since I had never been involved with the consumer of intelligence information and this provided me with that opportunity. In this position I received Top Secret clearances on some very highly classified projects and operations, about which I had only heard of peripherally. One of these was the U-2 project which involved flights over the Soviet Union by a specially constructed aircraft designed to fly at about 70,000 ft.out

of the range of the surface to air missile capability of the Soviet Union. By the time that I received my clearance, the operation had been going on for four years. It was soon destined to come to a halt. In May 1960, one of the U-2's piloted by Gary Powers was successfully shot down by a Soviet SAM. Initially, we expected to be able to plausibly deny it since it was presumed that if one of the U-2's were ever shot down the pilot would be killed or be able to use his L-pill to avoid being captured. This wasn't the case, however, and a big international incident occurred when Eisenhower, as President, denied that it was a spy plane, only to be confronted later with the evidence in the form of a living pilot and the wreckage of the plane and its cameras. The result of this disaster was the cancellation of a summit meeting scheduled between Eisenhower and Khrushchev, one of those things that the Soviets relish when the United States ends up with egg on its face. The loss of the U2 wasn't such a big deal, however, since it was replaced eventually with the so-called spy satellites (SAMOS) which are launched by both the Soviets and the United States to keep track of about everything that goes on on the surface of the earth of a military nature.

I also participated by providing requirements in an operation involving Colonel Oleg Penkovsky, a member of the Soviet GRU, the Military Intelligence Directorate. Penkovsky supplied Western Intelligence (the British and the Americans) with an immense amount of information on Soviet missile systems. He ultimately got caught and executed but the information he provided helped the U.S. to determine that the Soviets were placing offensive missile systems in Cuba which, had they been successful, would have materially altered the balance of power and resulted in the Soviets being able to bracket much of the United States with medium range ballistic missiles. The historic Cuban Missile crisis was the result of this attempt by Khrushchev to alter the strategic position with the U.S. Penkovsky's information undoubtedly saved the United States from a major military disaster. If anyone ever doubts the value of espionage they should remember this contribution which cost this man his life. One might want to read the book, The Penkovsky Papers, which I have in my library. This book was published by the Central Intelligence Agency in fulfillment of a promise made to Penkovsky to tell his story after his death.

In August of 1960, the family went on a vacation to visit some American and L.D.S. church historical sites. We visited the famous battlefield of Gettysburg, Niagara Falls, and Palmyra, New York and the Hill Cumorah where Joseph Smith received the gold plates on which the Book of Mormon was inscribed, from the hands of the Angel Moroni, a resurrected being who was an inhabitant of early America and participated in some of the events written about in the Book of Mormon.

Our second son, Hilton Richard, was born on Dec. 9, 1960, in a Washington, D.C. hospital so that all of our children were born in different locations. On Christmas Day, following our Sacrament meeting, all the family, except Marion and Hilton, was involved in a head-on automobile accident just about a quarter of a mile from home on Franconia Rd. There had been a car stalled on this narrow road and we had been waved around only to find that there was another car coming full speed and there was no chance to swerve or get out of the way. The little Falcon we were in was knocked about 160 feet back from the car we were trying to pass. I suffered severe facial lacerations and eight broken ribs from the steering column (no seats belts then) and Ron (age eleven at that time) was nearly thrown through the windshield. He broke his jaw and lost four of his lower permanent teeth. The girls, having learned from our Uruguay experience, had dropped to the bottom of the back seat and were not injured. This was the only time in my life that I had been involved in anything but a fender bender in an automobile but it made me a firm believer in wearing seatbelts.

It took some time to recover from the accident although the car was just slight of being totaled so we got it repaired. It hadn't been much of a contest between it and the Buick sedan which struck it just off-center. The police were never able to identify the car which had been stalled and which waved us into the path of the oncoming vehicle. Ron lost some permanent teeth and had to have a small plate constructed which throughout the years he has outgrown and had to have replaced. We were very fortunate that he wasn't thrown completely through the windshield where even more damage could have been done to him.

The next year, 1961, was a busy one for us. We had contracted to have a new house built for us in the City of Fairfax by George Elmore, a member of the Falls Church ward and a lot of the early part of 1961 was taken up with the plans and overseeing the construction of the colonial-style house on a wooded half-acre in an area called Cobbdale.

In March of 1961, I took a trip to Europe with our division chief, Jack Maury, and chief of operations, Quentin Johnson, to discuss with the British intelligence service various operational matters. Some things dealing with the Penkovsky operation and other matters involving possibly penetration of the British service by moles. Of course, the latter was all too true, and because of this penetration and the dissemination of the material he had produced, the Soviets began to investigate Penkovsky, who continued providing a wealth of information to us but eventually was picked up. He was tried and finally executed in May of 1963.

When I returned from my trip I was met by our neighbor, Werner Dickenson, instead of by Marion as I had been expecting. Just the afternoon before I was scheduled to arrive at the airport, Patty had fallen on her bike and was in the hospital in a coma. Marion and our home teacher had spent the night with her. We stayed with her for a number of hours trying to wake her up but that didn't occur until about twenty-four hours after her fall. However, she did come out of it none the worse for wear and we were all very grateful. Patty had been riding a two-wheeler from the time she was four years old in Uruguay so by this time, almost seven years of age she was pretty proficient. She had simply slipped on some gravel while making a quick turn because there was an automobile approaching.

Our new house was finished in April, 1961 and we moved in to the house which was one with six bedrooms, family room, living room, family eating area, kitchen, and three full baths, about everything that a family could want. It cost us somewhat over \$35,000, a lot of money for those days and the interest rate was a horrendous 5.25 percent. We were members of the Falls Church Ward as a result of our move. Having been in the Arlington Ward prior to our assignment in Germany, we knew quite a few people in the Ward which had been divided off of the old Arlington Ward.

In May 1961 we were visited by Helen and Jay Jeppsen, Marion's sister and brother-in-law and their children, Paul, Pamela, and Jody. Amongst the places we planned to visit was Williamsburg, Va. On the day we were scheduled to leave I came down with something which caused a terrible vertigo and which was later diagnosed as mumps encephalitis, although I had had the mumps when I was a sophomore in high school. As a result of this disease which was terribly debilitating I was off of work for almost six weeks, right in the beginning of our operational season at the Agency.

When I did return to work I went full steam at organizing an activity which paid off in a tremendous intelligence coup. It had been an outstanding requirement to try to ascertain if and when the Soviets had gone operational with their medium range ballistic missiles (MRBMs) in the Carpatho-Ukraine area, something which would result in placing our European allies within the range of the Soviet missiles. We were utilizing any person who could go in and out of the Soviet Union legally, i.e. students, reporters, businessmen, attaches, etc. for any ostensible reason. I was responsible for coordinating the intelligence collection effort by routing the various sources past a given railroad junction in the Carpatho-Ukraine over a period of approximately four months. There were certain clues or indicators which we were seeking regarding the number and types of railroad cars, particularly tank cars used for the transport of liquid oxygen (LOX). The travelers were asked to report on what they saw (photos were prohibited, although some of the more daring sources

obtained some anyhow) including details on whether tank cars were empty or full (if full the venting of the LOX looked like steam coming out). I kept a master chart of everyone going in and out and the dates when they would pass the particular intersection which was so critical to us. Working with various case officers, we scheduled the sources so that someone would be passing the selected spot (Brest) almost everyday during the four month period. Information by non-briefed travelers was also being collected by our Contacts Division.

Analytical collation of the information obtained from this operational activity later that year (1961) determined that the Soviets did, in fact, go operational with their MRBM's in the summer of 1961, a significant addition to their military capability vis a vis NATO powers. Incidentally, our U2 and satellite operations would ordinarily have provided this type of information. However, because of almost constant cloud cover in this region it had been impossible to obtain photographs, so we had to rely on the human element to obtain the necessary information.

In the fall of 1961, I left the Requirements component and was made Deputy Chief of the Soviet Division's Counter-Intelligence Branch. I served approximately one year in this component and it was during this time that several of the most important defectors from Soviet military and intelligence came into our hands, some of whom provided a great deal of useful information and others who remained an enigma so far as their bona fides was concerned. The legitimacy of a defector will always be problematical given the professional capability of the Soviet intelligences services to give away a lot of information with the hopes of effecting a penetration of the U.S. Intelligence Services, principally C.I.A. Some of our officers found their careers built or blighted by the positions they took re the bona fides of certain defectors. Generally speaking I was usually quite fortunate in the choices and input that I made into these matters.

In the late winter of 1961, McLean Ward was created from a division of the Falls Church Ward and we became members of the new ward, with our good friend, Julian Lowe, as the Bishop. Marion became the Primary President and I was given the job of Chairman of the Building Fund Committee, something which was quite new to me but certainly represented a challenge. The O'Bryants were also in the McLean Ward and together with the Julian Lowe family we started a tradition of holding our New Year's Eve celebration together, including all the children, something which continued until we left on our assignment to Rio de Janeiro in 1965.

Patty was baptized in March 1962. She was a delightful little girl and we enjoyed her very much. We never saw anyone quite so excited as she was when Marion was pregnant with Hilton back in 1960, everyone in the school knew about it.

In the summer of 1962, we rented a small vacation cabin from one of my colleagues at work, Betty Swantek. It was located in Davis, West Virginia near the Blackwater Falls. We took our dog, Frisky, with us and everyone had a good time since it seems to be the vacation all of the children remember. One of the things we were able to do was pick wild blackberries and Marion made a delicious pie from them with the ingredients she could find in the cabin. It also happened that the O'Bryants were vacationing in the same area in their recreational vehicle so we were able to spend some time with them as well.

Ron became an Eagle Scout in October, 1962. He had just turned thirteen the previous February so we were really thrilled and pleased that he had done so well in his scout work. He continued getting additional merit badges and was able to obtain the Order of the Arrow award as well, something which resulted in his being asked to usher at the inaugural parade of Lyndon Johnson. On several occasions I went with the boy scout troop as an extra adult to help out, an activity which tries one's patience to say the least.

Also in the fall, 1962, I was made a Branch Chief again, this time of a component known as SR/6. This was a branch designed to supply research support for our division's operational activity. My job was primarily to see if the Branch were really needed and that it was not just an anachronism from our previous illegal entry operations, i.e. providing cover stories, documentation, research, etc. for agents sent into the Soviet Union by parachute, subs or PT boats. The emphasis was re-oriented to have the branch monitor all persons in contact with Soviets inside or outside of the Soviet Union. Ultimately, I came to the conclusion that the Branch was no longer valid as a separate entity and was asked in 1963 by the new chief of the division, David Murphy, to help him reorganize the SR Division along more realistic lines. Dave had been my first boss in 1950 and was also the Deputy Chief of the Combined Soviet Operations Base in Munich, Germany.

Sometime in February 1963 we received a visit from Howard Anderson, his wife, Ila Rose (my sister) and their children Dwayne and Sandra to our home in Fairfax, Virginia. Also about this time Patty contracted mononucleosis, a debilitating disease and she had to stay home and have a home-bound teacher come to the house. During this year we also bought a "second car" since Marion was so involved in Primary and I at work. It was a large Buick station wagon, coral-colored and became known as the "pink elephant".

In late summer we planned a vacation to Rehobeth Beach in Maryland on the Atlantic shore. All of us couldn't go because Hilton contracted the mumps. Marion stayed home with him while I took Ron and the two girls, Gail and Patty. We had a good time together riding bikes along the boardwalk and body-surfing in the water but we all ended up with some bad sunburns. Marion's mother, Rhoda Jones, also visited us during the summer of 1963.

In early September, Marion and I and her sister Mildred and her husband, Jessco, went (along with other people from the Ward) to the Miss America contest in Atlantic City, New Jersey. One of the girls from the ward, Roseanne Tueller, had won the Miss Washington, D.C. contest and thus was entitled to compete in the main event in Atlantic City. She did quite well by winning the position of first runner-up and got a lot of flowers and trophies to display. We carried all the flowers back in a station wagon--can't remember whether it was ours or Jess Nixon's.

In November, 1963, President John F. Kennedy was assassinated in Dallas, Texas by Lee Oswald, an event which was to occupy the Congress of the United States for a long time in trying to ferret out whether or not there was any foreign involvement. After I retired and moved to Arizona I received a call from the Select Committee on Assassination to ask me if I knew anything about the possible involvement of Lee Harvey Oswald with the K.G.B. My predecessor as Chief of SR/6 had noted that Lee Harvey Oswald was living in the Soviet Union and the function of that branch was to keep track of such individuals for purposes of possible intelligence exploitation. He wrote a memo to that effect on Oswald and that memo eventually became known to the investigators. Although I was the successor chief of the branch I was never aware of the existence of the memo so the only thing that I could tell them was that if there had been any follow up to contacting Oswald while in the Soviet Union I probably would have been aware of it.

On the home front things were busy as usual, Marion involved in Primary activities and I in the building fund for the McLean Ward. From June 24-25, 1964, Marion went to the New York World's Fairs to sing with a multi-regional Singing Mothers' group. Things were progressing re the plans for the McLean Ward and a beautiful lot was purchased overlooking the area where the beltway was going to be built. The ward constructed an amphitheatre on a slope of the hill near the top of the lot and Marion was instrumental in starting an annual Fourth of July pancake breakfast tradition. We did manage to get away for a summer vacation. Instead of driving back to Utah as we would normally do, we decided to take a leisurely train trip rather than struggle with four children in an automobile. It turned out fine and is an adventure that we will always remember. Our

accommodations were usually quite adequate and there was ample opportunity to see parts of the United States which we had never seen before from our automobile trips. We did have some excitement on the trip when just outside of Chicago someone threw a rock at the train and it hit the window right next to where Gail was sitting.

Rex and Edith Johnson left the area in the summer of 1964. He had reached age 65, the mandatory retirement age for professors at George Washington University, and had a chance to continue on until age 70 as a professor of marketing at the University of Nevada at Las Vegas. We were sorry to see them go since we and our children had had a lot of delightful visits with them in their lovely home in Arlington, Virginia. Aunt Edith always had a jar full of candy treats for the children to reach into for a snack.

Time was getting ripe for my going overseas again and arrangements were made to send me to Stockholm as the Deputy Chief of Station. It seemed everything was going along all right until the Chief of Station found out that I was a Mormon and he said that the demands of the station could only be met by someone who could toss off drinks with the Swedes. Dave Murphy was furious about it but everyone concluded that it would be futile to fight the issue. However, as a result of my working hand in glove with the division chief in the reorganization of SR Division I was promoted to GS-15 and eventually became Chief of Operations and Plans for the Division, more or less a staff job which gave me a fancy office and a lot of prestige but really not much authority over the division's operations since Dave Murphy, being basically a field operations man, was essentially his own chief of operations.

From this slot, however, I was able to find out where the good assignments were emerging and eventually find out that a slot as head of Soviet/Satellite Operations in Rio de Janeiro would be available in the early part of 1965. Consequently, as soon as I returned from our train trip to Utah in the fall of 1964, I went with a colleague, Walt Sedoff, to Rio de Janeiro for about six weeks to make contact with a Soviet official in the Soviet Embassy's Commercial Section. This official had been approached briefly in another part of the world and had indicated a willingness to provide information to us.